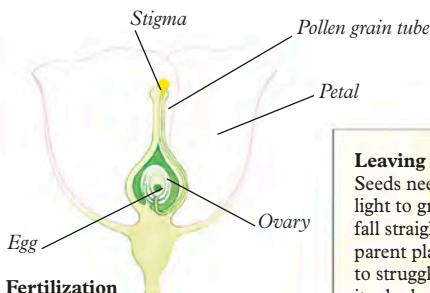


FLOWERS BECOME FRUITS

After they have been pollinated, flowers produce seeds and fruits. The fruits protect the seeds and keep them safe until the time comes for them to grow. Like flowers, fruits come in all sorts of shapes and sizes. Horse chestnuts make chestnuts, dandelions make parachutes, and plum trees make plums. Every fruit has its own kind of seed. Some are light enough to be blown away on the wind, others are armor-plated so they can be swallowed by animals and pass out in their droppings without being damaged!

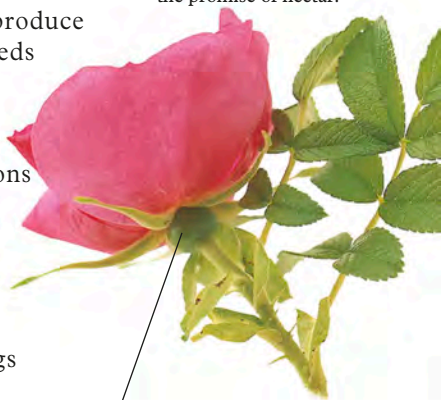


Fertilization

When an insect leaves some pollen on the stigma of a flower, fertilization can take place. Each tiny pollen grain grows a long tube. The tube grows down until it reaches the ovary where eggs are produced. Now a male gamete from the pollen tube joins with an egg from the ovary, and a seed is born.

From rose to hip

Bees are attracted to this rose by its sweet smell and the promise of nectar.



1. The swelling beneath the flower is called the receptacle, and it will become the fruit.

Leaving home

Seeds need space and light to grow. If they fall straight off the parent plant, they have to struggle to grow in its shadow. So plants use all sorts of clever devices for making sure their seeds are carried away from them by wind or animals. Some have exploding pods that catapult the seeds into the air.

